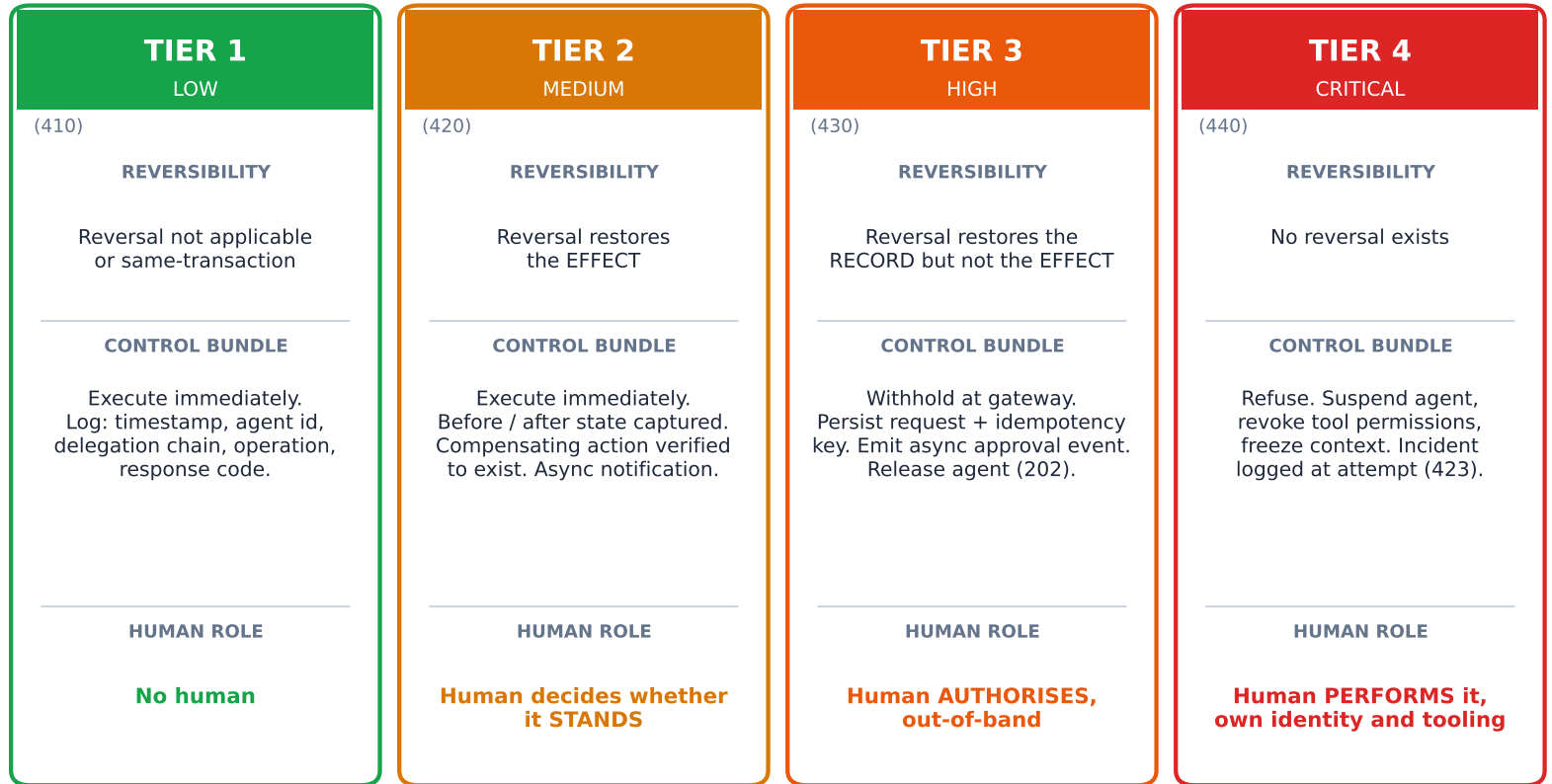


FIG. 4

Four-tier consequence model: criteria, controls and the locus of the human



increasing consequence of incorrect execution →

At tiers 3 and 4 (430, 440) the human is NEVER in the API request path.

The enforcement point withholds or refuses execution and emits an asynchronous event; the human acts out-of-band, without a connection being held open.

FIG. 5

Consequence tiering matrix: representative agent action types and assigned tiers

Action Category	Agent Action Type	Tier	Primary Condition	Governance Response	Rollback	Human Gate
Data access	De-identified metadata retrieval	Tier 1	Reversible; no regulatory sensitivity	Log only	N/A	No
	Sensitive read — authorised workflow	Tier 2	Regulatory sensitivity	Log + rollback verify	Soft	No — async
	Sensitive read — out-of-workflow	Tier 3	Regulatory + scope conditions	Withhold + authorise	Yes	Yes
Content generation	Internal reasoning output	Tier 1	No external effect	Log only	N/A	No
	Draft prepared for human review	Tier 2	Output presented, not sent	Log + rollback verify	Soft	No — async
	Externally-directed communication	Tier 3	External communication	Withhold + authorise	Yes	Yes
Record modification	Internal agent memory update	Tier 1	Fully reversible, no external effect	Log only	Auto	No
	Administrative record update	Tier 3	Reversal restores record only	Withhold + authorise	Yes	Yes
	Regulated record modification	Tier 4	Irreversible intervention	Suspend + takeover	Mandatory	Yes
External comms	Third-party submission	Tier 3	External + financial consequence	Withhold + authorise	Yes	Yes
	Binding external initiation	Tier 4	Irreversible intervention	Suspend + takeover	Mandatory	Yes
Process initiation	Downstream read-only trigger	Tier 2	Initiates tier 2 action	Log + rollback verify	Soft	No
	Downstream modifying trigger	Tier 3	Delegation condition (d)	Withhold + authorise	Yes	Yes
Agent delegation	Sub-agent delegation — tier 1/2	Tier 2	Delegation chain governance	Log + scope verification	Soft	No
	Sub-agent delegation — tier 3/4	Tier 3	Delegation condition (d)	Withhold + authorise	Yes	Yes
	Authority expansion at delegation	Tier 4	Delegation condition (d)	Suspend + takeover	Mandatory	Yes

Tier assignments shown are default assignments recorded at design time (see 500). Runtime resolution may raise an assignment on accumulated consequence, delegation-chain integrity, or request content exceeding the bounds assumed; runtime adjustment is unidirectional and never lowers a recorded assignment.